



MARTECH ATTRIBUTION

Last-click is misdirecting your budget.

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THE ATTRIBUTION LIE



Last-click credits the wrong touchpoint.

- Last-click ignores 6-12 touchpoints that built intent
- Typically credits paid search for organic-driven purchase
- Misdirects budget toward closing channels, not building channels
- B2B buyer journeys average 17 touchpoints before decision





MULTI-TOUCH MODELS



Four models. One right answer.

- Linear: equal credit across all touchpoints
- Time-decay: more credit to recent touchpoints
- Position-based: 40% to first and last, 20% to middle
- Data-driven: ML-based credit from outcome data





DATA-DRIVEN ATTRIBUTION



The model that holds up in 2026.

- Uses closed-loop conversion data as training signal
- Shapley value approach: fair credit by causal contribution
- Continuously updated as buyer behavior shifts
- Incrementality testing validates model accuracy





INCREMENTALITY TESTING



Test that attribution reflects reality.

- Holdout groups measure true incremental impact
- Ghost bidding validates paid channel contribution
- Geo-based testing for channel-level incrementality
- Results feed back into attribution model calibration





BUDGET REALLOCATION



Where the budget should actually go.

- Brand awareness channels typically under-credited at last-click
- Mid-funnel content often drives more pipeline than it receives credit for
- Retargeting over-credited: would have converted anyway
- Incrementality data drives reallocation decisions





IMPLEMENTATION STEPS



Build attribution that actually works.

- Step 1: unified cross-channel event stream with timestamps
- Step 2: closed-loop conversion data within 48 hours
- Step 3: data-driven model on 90 days of history minimum
- Step 4: incrementality testing to validate model output





WHAT FAILS



Attribution pitfalls to avoid.

- Models built on last-click data inherit last-click bias
- Attribution without incrementality validation misleads budget
- Single-channel models that ignore cross-channel paths
- Models updated annually instead of continuously





CODISTE AI

Build attribution that directs budget right.

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